

THE FUTURE OF MANUFACTURING

“The decisions we make today will shape our future”

ALAN MULALLY

PRESIDENT & CEO, FORD MOTORS

Over the years, with Boeing and now with Ford, I have witnessed India's development and growth and I have been so proud and pleased to contribute to that progress. As a nation, India has generated tremendous forward momentum creating endless potential for our future.

Because I have spent most of my career building jet aircraft, I am a big fan of forward momentum. But I have also learned that once you generate momentum, you need to focus a lot of attention on steering it. And as I know, you would each agree that this is no small task. The decisions we make today will shape the future for all of us for decades to come.

In the 1920s, Henry Ford set up automotive operations all around the world. He believed that his cars should be built where they were sold so the local economies and people would realise the direct and indirect benefits from job creation and employment economic stability and growth. Henry said that since oil supplies were finite, we needed to shift to alternative fuels such as ethanol and electricity. So he invested heavily in alternative fuel research. And he was the first to introduce electric vehicles.

And as we dimension the challenge of energy independence, think about this: In 2008, India was the world's sixth-largest net importer of oil, importing 70 per cent of its total oil consumption. This is a significant challenge with many possible solutions. For example bio-fuels provide less than 3 per cent of transport energy today but India has set a target of having all petrol and diesel contain 20 per cent bio-fuel by 2017. To support this, there are plans to plant 11 million hectares of Jatropha, which can grow on arid land. These are global conversations in which each of us need to participate as leaders and as citizens.

When Henry originally set up our company, he built operations all around the world. He never envisioned that each one would come to operate independently. Today, Ford is no longer a collection of businesses scattered around the world but a single, integrated team that works to the same high standard that focuses on delivering the best cars and trucks. This effort to serve the world's customers is built through the energy and commitment of two lakh talented


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